

GRADE 6 MATHEMATICS

Classroom Observation Guide

Grade 6 Mathematics — Day Three: “Hear From Us”

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Prepared for visiting guests, administrators, and instructional observers.

Purpose of This Guide

Today's lesson is a deliberate change of format. The class does not yet have graph paper that the school's scanning equipment can reliably process, so rather than pause the Getting-to-Know-You momentum from Days One and Two, today's lesson moves the same goals - data literacy, self-expression, and classroom community - into an entirely oral and kinesthetic format. No student drawing or writing happens during class today. This guide explains why, what standards this still addresses, and the research behind the shift.

Lesson at a Glance (55 Minutes)

Time	Segment	What's Happening
0-3 min	Today: Skits! / It Only Takes One	A quick, high-energy tease that students will perform skits today, immediately followed by Professor Honablue's direct address on focus and how classroom time will be used.
3-6 min	Welcome Back	Students are told plainly that today has no drawing - the class is still waiting on scannable graph paper - and that voice and movement are today's tools instead.
6-9 min	Today's Plan	Overview of the Human Bar Graph, the behavior skits, and the Keep-or-Rid vote that follows each one.
9-16 min	Human Bar Graph	The class answers a multiple-choice question by physically standing in labeled lines, forming a live bar graph, and counting each line aloud together.
16-19 min	Meet Your Behavior Card	Small groups receive a scenario card describing either a focused or an off-task classroom moment, and plan a 30-60 second skit.

19-36 min	Skit Time	Groups perform their skits for the class; audience expectations (quiet, specific, respectful) are set beforehand.
36-45 min	Keep or Rid?	After each skit, the class votes aloud - keep this behavior, or get rid of it - and a few students explain their reasoning.
45-49 min	Building Our Focus Code	The class names 3-5 concrete behaviors from the “keep” skits, and the teacher records them live as a shared classroom reference.
49-52 min	Oral Exit Ticket	Students say one word aloud on their way out describing how they want to show focus tomorrow, then write that word and a short reason in their journal that evening.

Why the Format Changed Today

Days One and Two used graph paper, rulers, and geometric shapes as the medium for the Getting-to-Know-You survey work, with the explicit plan of scanning that student work so it can be turned into personalized word problems throughout the year. The classroom does not yet have the specific graph paper that scanning equipment can process cleanly. Rather than either collect unusable paper or pause the unit, today's lesson keeps the same underlying goals - data literacy, self-expression, and classroom community-building - but delivers them entirely through speech and movement.

Today's Two Core Activities

Human Bar Graph

The teacher poses a question with three or four possible answers. Each answer is assigned a spot in the room, and students physically walk to and line up at the spot matching their answer. Each line counts off out loud together, and the class compares which line - which bar - is tallest or shortest. This is the same data-display skill as a paper bar graph (6.SP.B.4), built with people instead of a ruler.

Classroom Behavior Skits & Keep-or-Rid Voting

Small groups draw a scenario card describing either a focused classroom moment or an off-task one, and perform a brief skit. After each skit, the whole class votes out loud - keep this behavior, or get rid of it - and several students explain their reasoning. This directly reuses the keep-or-rid survey structure from Day Two, now applied to behavior rather than personal preferences such as favorite fruit.

Sample scenario cards used today include a student raising a quiet hand versus talking during independent work, and two students calmly explaining their thinking versus arguing over an answer. Both a focused and an off-task version of each situation are included so students see clear contrast, not just a list of rules.

Common Core & Michigan Standards Addressed

English Language Arts: Speaking & Listening

- **SL.6.1:** Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions - group skit planning, class voting, and the Focus Code discussion.
- **SL.6.4:** Present claims and findings, using appropriate eye contact, adequate volume, and clear pronunciation - the skit performances.
- **SL.6.6:** Adapt speech to a variety of contexts and tasks - performing in character versus explaining a vote as oneself.

Mathematics

- **6.SP.B.4:** Display data - the Human Bar Graph, built with people instead of paper.
- **6.SP.B.5:** Summarize a data set in relation to its context - comparing which line/bar was tallest and why.
- **MP3:** Construct viable arguments and critique the reasoning of others - defending a Keep or Rid vote out loud.

Social-Emotional Learning

Today connects to the CASEL competencies of social awareness (reading a scene and naming the behavior accurately) and relationship skills (planning and performing together as a group), and continues the self-management thread introduced during Day Two's growth-mindset discussion.

Pedagogical & Cognitive Research Foundations

Teaching Behavior Through Modeling and Role-Play (PBIS)

Having students act out both expected and unexpected classroom behaviors, rather than simply being told a list of rules, reflects the Positive Behavioral Interventions and Supports (PBIS) framework (Sugai & Horner, 2009), which treats behavior as directly teachable: define the expectation, model examples and non-examples, and give students structured practice - exactly the sequence today's skits and Keep-or-Rid vote follow.

Embodied Cognition and Kinesthetic Learning

The Human Bar Graph activity is grounded in embodied cognition research, which finds that physically enacting a concept - rather than only viewing it as a symbol or drawing - strengthens understanding, particularly for spatial and quantitative ideas (Abrahamson, 2004). Turning the class itself into a bar graph gives students a bodily, not just visual, experience of what a bar's height represents.

Continued Foundations From Days One and Two

Today's lesson continues to draw on the gradual release of responsibility (Pearson & Gallagher, 1983) in how the Human Bar Graph is introduced (modeled, then handed to students), and on the growth-mindset and funds-of-knowledge foundations introduced on Days One and Two, now expressed through performance rather than drawing.

What to Look For as an Observer

- How quickly and accurately students self-sort into the correct line during the Human Bar Graph - this is a live, informal check of data categorization.
- The specificity of language during the Keep-or-Rid discussion - listen for students naming an exact behavior rather than a vague judgment ("she raised her hand instead of shouting out," not just "that was good").
- Audience behavior during skits - quiet, attentive watching is itself a live demonstration of the very focus behaviors being discussed.
- Whether the Focus Code that emerges is genuinely student-generated language, not the teacher's own classroom-rules wording restated.

Appendix: Day Three in the Grade 6 Math Lesson Plan Template

For administrators cross-referencing today's observation against the school's required weekly lesson plan format, the table below shows how today's lesson populates that same template.

Template Field	Day Three Content
Standard(s) & Taxonomy Level	SL.6.1, SL.6.4, SL.6.6, 6.SP.B.4, 6.SP.B.5, MP3 C/A
Learning Target(s) (SWBAT)	SWBAT build and interpret a data display using a physical, whole-class model; plan and perform a short skit that clearly represents a specific classroom behavior; and construct and defend an argument (Keep or Rid) using specific evidence.
Success Criteria (I Can)	I can help build and read a data display using real people instead of paper. I can plan and perform a short skit that clearly shows a specific behavior. I can vote on an idea and explain my reasoning out loud, using specific evidence.
Daily Marzano Strategies	Helping Students Engage in Cognitively Complex Tasks; Helping Students Examine Their Reasoning; Helping Students Practice Skills, Strategies, and Processes
Do-Now (5 min)	Students are told plainly that today has no drawing, and that voice and movement are today's tools instead.
Instructional Plan	Whole-class Human Bar Graph warm-up using a multiple-choice question. Small groups receive a behavior scenario card and prepare a brief skit. Groups perform; after each skit the class votes Keep or Rid and explains their reasoning. The class collaboratively builds a Focus Code from the patterns observed across the "keep" skits.
Critical Content Debrief (5 min)	Can students accurately name the specific behavior shown in a skit, and defend a Keep or Rid vote with concrete evidence rather than a vague opinion?
Daily Formative [Ungraded] / Summative [Graded] Assessments	Formative: teacher observation during the Human Bar Graph, skit planning, and voting discussion; the co-built

Focus Code as a class artifact. Summative: none today - an oral exit ticket and evening journal entry serve as the individual reflection.

Planning to Close the Achievement Gap Using Data

Tier 1 Supports	Tier 2 Supports	Tier 3 Supports
Clear modeling of the Human Bar Graph before students move; explicit performer and audience expectations stated before any skit begins.	Pre-written, simplified scenario cards for groups needing extra scaffolding; sentence starters for explaining a Keep or Rid vote ("I voted keep because...").	Option for a student to narrate a skit rather than perform an active role; one-to-one check-in during group planning for students who need support engaging verbally.

Data Source: Classroom Formative Assessments [Ungraded]; teacher observation notes.

Explore More: Resources for Observers

For guests who would like to look deeper into the frameworks behind today's shift to oral and kinesthetic learning.

PBIS: Teaching Behavior Expectations

The OSEP Technical Assistance Center on PBIS's overview of teaching expected behavior through modeling and practice - the foundation for today's skits.

[View on pbis.org](#)

Standards for Mathematical Practice

The official Common Core description of MP3 and the other Standards for Mathematical Practice referenced throughout this unit.

[View on corestandards.org](#)

Embodied Cognition in the Classroom

An accessible overview of embodied and kinesthetic learning research and its classroom applications, relevant to today's Human Bar Graph.

[Read the overview](#)

CASEL SEL Framework

The Collaborative for Academic, Social, and Emotional Learning's five core competencies, which ground the social-awareness and relationship-skills elements of today's lesson.

[View on casel.org](#)

References

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Sugai, G., & Horner, R. H. (2009). Responsiveness-to-intervention and school-wide positive behavior supports: Integration of multi-tiered system approaches. *Exceptionality*, 17(4), 223-237.